MIRGASIM ART™

FINE ART ATELIER • BAKU & ABSHERON

CURATORIAL COMMISSION DOSSIER

Absheron Tectonics: Primordial Matter & Geological Strata

Prepared Exclusively for Gazelli Art House (London / Baku)

> *"True regional modernism does not decorate with heritage; it builds directly from the primordial substances of the land: crystallized pink salt, volcanic craquelure, and ancient hydrocarbons."*

Responding to the international fine art standards of **Gazelli Art House**, this 5-work suite channels the modernist lineage of the **Absheron School** (Javad Mirjavadov, Sattar Bahlulzade, Rasim Babayev). Abandoning superficial decorative clichés and tourist carpet motifs, this collection explores authentic Absheron signatures through radical mineral materiality and Caspian endemism.

PLATE	ARTWORK TITLE	DIMENSIONS	PRIMARY ABSHERON MATERIAL	CASPIAN MOTIF
01	*Strata of Masazir: Crystalline Salt Landscape*	185 × 120 cm	Masazir Pink Lake Salt, Plaster	Lacustrine Evaporites
02	*The Shebeke Reliquary: Fossil Didacna*	150 × 200 cm	Coquina Stone, Coastal Sand	*Didacna* Cockle Shells
03	*The Binagadi Derrick: Hydrocarbon Strata*	120 × 200 cm	Binagadi Bitumen, Pyrite Ore	Caspian Marine Shad
04	*[Work in Progress / Forthcoming Atelier Review]*	180 × 180 cm	Volcanic Clay, Celadon Glazes	Caspian Tadpole Goby
05	*The Gobustan Solar Oracle: Lamprey*	100 × 150 cm	Beach Sand, Lake Salt, Plaster	Caspian Lamprey Mandala

Conservation Protocol: All raw substances are bound under archival museum standards: Masazir salt crystals are oven-dehydrated and sealed in UV-matte acrylic fixative; mud-volcano craquelure is co-polymer stabilized; and bitumen is mineral-dissolved into durable polymer glazes.

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PLATE 01 • PURE MINERAL ABSTRACTION

Strata of Masazir: Crystalline Salt Landscape

Masazır Layları: Çəhrayı Duz Abstraksiyası



DIMENSIONS	**185 × 120 cm** (Horizontal Landscape Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MATERIALS	Genuine Masazir Pink Lake Salt, Porous Absheron Limestone Plaster, Heavy Impasto, Incised Sgraffito
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	A serene, meditative abstract landscape capturing the primordial mineral strata of Lake Masazir. Soft undulating terraces of rose-quartz, blush pink, and warm alabaster white are built with thick palette-knife impasto. Embedded in high relief are sparkling crystalline salt clusters, scored with delicate geometric sgraffito fissures. Completely non-figurative; zero portraits, zero seals, zero carpets.

ALTERNATIVE STUDY VARIATIONS (STUDIO ITERATIONS)



Study B: *Stepped Crystalline Salt Terraces*



Study C: *Atmospheric Sunrise over Misty Saline Shoreline*

PLATE 02 • ARCHITECTURAL MASONRY & FOSSIL STRATA

The Shebeke Reliquary: Fossil Didacna in Absheron Stone

Şəbəkə Qalığı: Qədim Didakna və Daş Pəncərə



DIMENSIONS	**150 × 200 cm** (Vertical Monumental Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Porous Coquina Stone Relief, Absheron Beach Sand Plaster, Fossilized Caspian *Didacna* Shells in High Sculptural Relief, Turquoise & Lapis Lazuli Glazes
ENDEMIC ORGANISM	Caspian Cockle (*Didacna trigonoides* / *Didacna pyramidata*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	Honoring Absheron's ancient stone-carving heritage (*daş yonma*), a heavy coquina wall reveals an intricate geometric stone Shebeke window lattice. Behind the carved aperture glow deep Caspian turquoise and lapis lazuli glazes. Protruding from the masonry are radiant *Didacna* cockles, while an elongated sculpted hand touches the stone frame, linking human craftsmanship with deep geological time.

PLATE 03 • INDUSTRIAL-GEOLOGICAL ABSTRACTION

The Binagadi Derrick: Hydrocarbon Strata & Pyrite Shad

Binaqədi Buruğu: Qara Qızıl və Pirit Şad



DIMENSIONS	**120 × 200 cm** (Vertical Panoramic Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Raw Unrefined Binagadi Bitumen, Pyrite Sulfide Aggregates, Chalky Limestone Contrast Sgraffito, Oil & Industrial Asphaltite Knife Impasto
ENDEMIC WILDLIFE	Caspian Marine Shad / Brazhnikov's Shad (*Alosa braschnikowi*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	Confronting Baku's historic role as the pioneer of world petroleum, minimal structural scaffolding beams inspired by historic wooden oil derricks slice across visceral slabs of pitch-black Binagadi bitumen. Leaping through the dark matrix is an armored Caspian marine shad adorned with metallic golden pyrite ore, set above the eternal subterranean gas flame (*Yanar Dağ / Ateshgah*).

PLATE 04 • WORK IN PROGRESS / RESERVED

[Work 04: Atelier Development in Progress]

Lökbatan Nəfəsi: Yeni Seriya Üzərində İş Gedir



STATUS	**Reserved for Forthcoming Atelier Review** (Work in Progress)
TARGET DIMENSIONS	**180 × 180 cm** (Square Format 1:1, Specification from Brief)
PROPOSED MEDIUM	Subterranean Lokbatan Mud-Volcano Clay, Luminous Caspian Greenish-Blue Mineral Glazes (Celadon, Seafoam, Verdigris), Natural Craquelure Fissures & Pyrite Vein Infiltration
PROPOSED ENDEMIC FAUNA	Armored Caspian Tadpole Goby (*Benthophilus* spp.)
CURATORIAL NOTE	Work #4 is currently being redesigned from scratch in the atelier to replace earlier dark earthy tones with radiant, pleasing Caspian greenish-blue palettes and a strict 1:1 square composition. The final artwork plate and alternative studies will be integrated upon completion of the new generation series.

PLATE 05 • MYTHOLOGICAL ARCHAEOLOGICAL TOTEM

The Gobustan Solar Oracle: Ouroboros Lamprey

Qobustan Günəşi: İlanbalığı və Qədim Qaya Təsvirləri



DIMENSIONS	**100 × 150 cm** (Vertical Portrait Canvas, Specification from Brief)
MEDIUM / TECHNIQUES	Absheron Coastal Beach Sand Mandala, Masazir Salt Encrustations, Incised Gobustan Petroglyphic Sgraffito, Oil & Bone Plaster on Linen
ENDEMIC WILDLIFE	Caspian Lamprey (*Caspiomyzon wagneri*)
CURATORIAL CONCEPT	A transcendental contemporary altar piece uniting prehistoric rock art with ecological mystery. The ancient Caspian lamprey coils into an Ouroboros circle of eternity around a concentric sand-and-salt solar mandala. Incised directly into the bone-plaster and limestone ground are Gobustan petroglyphs (reed boats, hunters, and sacred solar bulls), immortalizing Absheron's ancient rock art heritage within deep cosmological time.